



Your home
is all set to
become the
central
computing
device of
your life

One World,

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We're on the verge of an age of convergence, and the very first place you'll interact with the new technologies will be at home. Manufacturers are in the fight of the millennium, trying to get into consumers' homes, trying to introduce technology solutions—and, consequently, their gadgets—into every aspect of your life.

The fine line between electronics and computing devices is almost invisible already—everything from music systems to cars have computer chips embedded in them, and they're touted to get a lot smarter.

We take a look here at what technologies and gadgets you can expect to see in your house over the next few years. Some of them have already been implemented, and are beginning to gain popularity, while others are still in the prototype stage, or have only just been envisioned.

Those with millions in the bank can possibly go out right away and get their house outfitted, just as is described in this article. The less fortunate among us will have to wait a few years.

The Living Room

The most important room in the house, the living room, is where the majority of gadgets being made are targeted. This is because this is the room where you and your family spend most of your waking hours—seeking entertainment. All entertainment devices can be broadly classified into two groups:

The Display Device: The TV is currently the default family entertainment centre, and thus, is a multi-billion dollar market. We have seen the TV go from a dumb visual output device to the interactive entertainment centre that it is today. With more technologies and companies coming up with increased interactivity, such as Direct To Home (DTH) and Pay-Per-View, and even more companies already offering Internet access to your TV via set-top boxes, it's merely a matter of time before the TV becomes a one-stop entertainment centre.

The Audio Device: Everyone loves music—it's just tastes in genres that differ. Today, music systems are already offering VCD, DVD, MP3, and Audio CD playback. Some digital entertainment centres come equipped with wireless networking so they can connect to your PC and stream audio and video to your audio and display devices.

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